FACT SHEET - INCOMING SEMESTER STUDENTS



University Information	
Portrait	The ZHAW School of Engineering, one of the leading Engineering Faculties in Switzerland, focuses on topics that will be relevant in the future. Our 14 institutes and centres guarantee high-quality education, research, and development, with an emphasis on the areas of energy, mobility, information, and health. Courses for Bachelor's / Undergraduate students are available in the following fields: • Aviation • Computer Science • Data Science • Electrical Engineering • Energy and Environmental Engineering • Engineering and Management • Mechanical Engineering • Medical Informatics • Mobility Science • Systems Engineering Courses for Master's / Graduate students are available in the following fields: • Aviation • Business Engineering • Civil Engineering • Computer Science • Data Science • Electrical Engineering • Energy and Environment • Information and Cyber Security • Mechanical Engineering • Mechatronics and Automation • Medical Engineering • Photonics and Laser Engineering
Location	The School of Engineering is located in Winterthur, 5 minutes from Winterthur main railway station and just a 20-minute train journey from Zürich. Excellent public transport links allow for easy and comfortable travel throughout the country. With Switzerland located in the "centre of Europe" and Zürich Airport nearby, most destinations in Europe can be reached within 2 hours.

Websites	Zurich University of Applied Sciences (ZHAW) School of Engineering (SoE) International Office SoE
International Relations and Office	
Partner Agreements **Learning Agreements**	Patricia Heuberger Head International Relations patricia.heuberger@zhaw.ch +41 58 934 72 83
Incoming Exchange	Sabrina Meinzinger Incoming Exchange Coordinator exchange.engineering@zhaw.ch +41 58 934 42 28
Address of International Office	ZHAW School of Engineering International Office Technikumstrasse 9 8401 Winterthur Switzerland

General information for Incoming Semester Students	
Semester dates BACHELOR	**Fall Semester – Bachelor's studies** Nomination deadline: **15 March** Application deadline: **1 April** Introduction days: Week 37 Start semester: Week 38 Christmas holiday: Week 52-1 Exam Preparation: Week 2 Exam: Week 3-4 *(no repetition possible)* End semester: Saturday, Week 4
	Spring Semester – Bachelor's studies Nomination deadline: **15 October** Application deadline: **1 November** Introduction days: Week 7 Start semester: Week 8 Exam Preparation: Week 22-24 Exam: Week 24-26 *(no repetition possible)* End semester: Saturday, Week 26
Semester dates MASTER	**Fall semester – Master's studies** Nomination deadline: **15 March** Application deadline: **1 April** Introduction days: Week 37 Start semester: Week 38 Christmas holiday: Week 52-1 Exam Preparation: Week 2-4 Exam: Week 5-6 *(resit exam week 25)* End semester: Saturday, Week 6
	Spring Semester – Master's studies Nomination deadline: **15 October** Application deadline: **1 November** Introduction days: Week 37 Start semester: Week 8 Exam Preparation: Week 23-25 Exam: Week 26-27 *(resit exam week 37)* End semester: Saturday, Week 27* *Exception: Block course week 29

Nomination and Application	The home institution nominates students using the designated nomination link. Nominated students will then receive access to our online application platform (Mobility-Online), including all necessary documents and instructions. Applications must be completed and submitted by the deadlines indicated above. Late nominations may be accepted for students who do not require a visa, but only after prior consultation with the International Office.
Language requirements	**For Bachelor's Programmes:** English: Level B2 (for courses in English) TOEIC L&R 785 TOEIC S&W 310 TOEFL iBT new 4 (old 72) IELTS 5.5 Cambridge FCE German: Level B2 (for courses in German) **For Master's Programmes:** English: Level C1 TOEIC L&R 945 TOEIC S&W 360 TOEFL iBT new 5.0 (old 95) IELTS 7.0 Cambridge FCE Certificate (not older than two years) or confirmation of home university as proof of skills.
Further Requirements	GPA 2.5 out of 4.0 or a good B Level. **For Bachelor's Programmes:** A minimum of four completed semesters equivalent of two years of studies prior to the exchange. **For Master's Programmes:** A minimum of one completed semester prior to the exchange.
Information on Courses	**For Bachelor's Programmes** All English modules are published on our website. **For Master's Programmes** All English modules are published on our website. Additionally, two exclusive modules are offerd for incoming students: German for Beginners; Introduction to Swiss Society and Politics
Grading System	Swiss Grade — ECTS Grade 6.0 = excellent — A 5.5 = very good — B 5.0 = good — C 4.5 = satisfactory — D 4.0 = sufficient — E <4.0 = fail — FX: further work is required F: complete fail or non-attendance of course or exam More Information about Swiss Education System A passing grade of 4.0 in the Swiss grading system is required to obtain ECTS credits (European Credit Transfer System).
Study Load per Semester	Full – time Students: 30 ECTS Minimum study load for incoming students: 15 ECTS Maximum study load for incoming students 30 ECTS
ZHAW School of Engineering Newsletter	We distribute a newsletter twice a year, in August and February. If you have not yet subscribed, you are welcome to do so via the provided link. In the meantime, feel free to check out our latest edition.
Social media	Instagram | LinkedIn



Accommodation, Cost of Living and Student Support	
Accommodation	Various off-campus accommodation options are available. Students are responsible for arranging their own accommodation and contracts. Further information can be found here: Student Accommodation
Estimated Cost of Living	Information on the expected cost of living can be found here.
Student Support	Support and Social Events are organized by ESN (Erasmus Student Network). As part of the Buddy Programme, alocal student is assigned to each incoming student.

Scholarship and SEMP/Erasmus	
SEMP/Erasmus+ Funds	Students from SEMP/Erasmus+ partner universities receive SEMP funding during their stay at the School of Engineering (SoE). The grant amounts to a maximum of CHF 1'900 or CHF 2'200 per semester, depending on the country of the home institution.
SEMP (ERASMUS+) ID Code	**CH WINTERT03**
Scholarship for Incoming Students at ZHAW School of Engineering	Incoming Exchange Students may apply for the "Scholarship for Incoming Students at ZHAW School of Engineering". This Scholarship is based on academic merit and financial need of the student. Amount of the scholarship: Students from within Europe: up to CHF 1'000 (excl. intra-Swiss students and those already receiving ERASMUS+ or other funding at their home university) Students from outside Europe: up to CHF 3'000 Further details will be provided together with the letter of acceptance.

Visa and Health Insurance	
Visa / Residence Permit	Non-EU citizens must apply for a student visa as early as possible after receiving their letter of acceptance. Students from Australia, Japan, New Zealand, Malaysia, Singapore, and the United Kingdom do not require a visa but must apply for a residence permit ("*Aufenthaltsbewilligung*") through the SoE International Office. All exchange students must apply for a residence permit (L-Permit) upon arrival. Proof of financial means (CHF 1'750 per month) is required for both visa and residence permit applications. Detailled information will be provided by the International Office after the application process.

	Further information on visa requirements and residence permits please read here.
Health Insurance	Basic health insurance is mandatory by law in Switzerland and can be obtained after the student's arrival. Detailed information will be provided during Orientation Week. Non-EU residents must purchase Swiss health insurance (starting from CHF 61 per month); international health insurance obtained in the student's home country is usually not sufficient. EU residents with EHIC cards are exempt from this obligation. They must submit a copy of their card, which must be valid for their entire stay in Switzerland. Further Information please read here.

Disclosure of information
Note that student information will be disclosed to the other institution as far as required for the administration process.

Ready for an exchange semester in Switzerland?
We are looking forward to your nomination!

